



Cambridge International AS Level

ENGLISH GENERAL PAPER

Paper 1 Essay

8021/12

May/June 2026

1 hour 15 minutes

You must answer on the enclosed answer booklet.

You will need: Answer booklet (enclosed)

INSTRUCTIONS

- Answer **one** question.
- Follow the instructions on the front cover of the answer booklet. If you need additional answer paper, ask the invigilator for a continuation booklet.
- Dictionaries are **not** allowed.

INFORMATION

- The total mark for this paper is 30.
- All questions are worth equal marks.

This document has **4** pages. Any blank pages are indicated.

Answer **one** question.

You are advised to write an essay of 600–700 words. Use examples to support your arguments.

- 1 Wealthy nations should always provide assistance to developing countries. Discuss this view. [30]
- 2 Reading and telling stories to young children is very important. Examine this statement. [30]
- 3 Possessing nuclear weapons is the best way for a country to avoid war. Evaluate this statement. [30]
- 4 A painting does not capture life as successfully as a photograph. Discuss. [30]
- 5 The only purpose of education is to obtain good qualifications. Evaluate this claim. [30]
- 6 'The role of men in bringing up children is essential in modern society.' Discuss. [30]
- 7 'The effects of natural disasters have become more severe due to human activity.' To what extent do you agree? [30]
- 8 'Scientific research intended to benefit human health should not face any restrictions.' Discuss. [30]
- 9 Advertising has a very negative impact on society. Evaluate this view. [30]
- 10 Artificial intelligence is changing people's lives for the better. To what extent do you agree with this statement? [30]

BLANK PAGE

BLANK PAGE

Permission to reproduce items where third-party owned material protected by copyright is included has been sought and cleared where possible. Every reasonable effort has been made by the publisher (Cambridge University Press & Assessment) to trace copyright holders, but if any items requiring clearance have unwittingly been included, the publisher will be pleased to make amends at the earliest possible opportunity.

To avoid the issue of disclosure of answer-related information to candidates, all copyright acknowledgements are reproduced online in our Copyright Acknowledgements Booklet. This is produced for each series of examinations and is freely available to download at www.cambridgeinternational.org after the live examination series.

Cambridge International Education is the name of our awarding body and a part of Cambridge University Press & Assessment, which is a department of the University of Cambridge.